**SONAM DHENDUP**

Chief Executive Attorney
Samdhen Legal Firm, Thimphu

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**Professional Summary:** Legally trained professional with specialized expertise in Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) and arbitration. Completed extensive academic study of ADR at the master's level, including comparative analysis of international best practices and domestic dispute resolution frameworks. Undertook comprehensive ADR and Mediation for Advocates training at the Bhutan National Legal Institute in 2020, followed by advanced certification and training in arbitration. Possesses strong knowledge of contract law and arbitration procedures, with substantial experience managing contractual and commercial cases as a practising lawyer since 2016. Brings a strong combination of academic grounding, professional training, and practical experience suitable for arbitration and dispute resolution roles

## EDUCATION

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**1. University of Asia Pacific, Dhaka,** Bangladesh
Master of laws 2022

**2. University of Calcutta**, West Bengal, India
B.A LL.B

**3. Royal Institute of Management**, Thimphu, Bhutan.
Post Graduate Diploma Course in National Law 2008

## EXPERIENCE

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**The Anti-Corruption Commission,** Thimphu, Bhutan.

*Assistant legal Officer* 2008-2011

Provided legal advice to Investigation Officers throughout corruption investigations, including reviewing Investigation Reports and making recommendations prior to referral to the Office of the Attorney General for prosecution. Actively participated in investigations, particularly in construction-sector corruption cases. Contributed to the drafting of the Anti-Corruption Act 2011 and key regulatory instruments, including the Gift Rules, Asset Declaration Rules, and Prosecution Referral Guidelines. Also assisted in developing 36 procedural forms to ensure compliance with due process in investigative procedures.

**Nyinda Legal Consultancy,** Thimphu, Bhutan.

*Executive Legal Counsel* *2016-2018*

Represented clients before various judicial bodies across Bhutan, including the District Courts, High Courts, and Supreme Court. Defended numerous cases, notably securing a landmark judgement from the Hon'ble Supreme court in the case of OAG v. Jamyang which relates to issues surrounding Spasmo Proxyvon Plus in 2017.

**Samdhen Legal consultancy,** Thimphu, Bhutan.

*Chief Executive Legal Counsel* *2018-2025*

Represented clients before various tiers of courts, achieving favourable outcomes in a diverse range of cases. Notably represented high-profile matters, including the Trongsa Land Case, (ACC v Lhab Dorji & ors) demonstrating expertise in complex legal disputes. Represented a few construction issues on behalf of clients before the tribunal.

**Bhutan Broadcasting Service**, Thimphu, Bhutan.

*Legal Advisor*

Provided comprehensive legal counsel across a broad range of organizational matters, ensuring compliance with applicable laws and regulations. Drafted policies and guidelines to enhance operational efficiency and statutory adherence. Advised on legal risks associated with new initiatives and projects to support informed decision-making. Conducted ongoing legal research to monitor legislative and policy developments, enabling proactive legal strategy for the organization.

## OTHER RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

**Professional Development and affiliations:**

**1. Royal Institute of Management,** Thimphu, *Procurement and Compliance* 2010

**2. Office of Attorney General**, *Legislative Drafting* 2009

**3. Malaysian Anti-Corruption Academy,** Malaysia**,** *Executive Certificate Course for Strategic Management of Anti-Corruption Programme*

**4. Corrupt Practices Bureau,**Singapore, *Anti-Corruption Management and Investigation*, 2008

**5. JSW Law College,** Paro, Bhutan, *Training of Trainer on Intellectual property* 2020

**6. Bhutan National Legal Institute,** Alternative Dispute Resolution and Mediation for Advocates 2020

**7. University of Asia Pacific,** Department of Law and Human Rights, Research and Writing skill 2022

**8. Bhutan Alternative Dispute Resolution Centre, SAARC Arbitration Council and Charted institute of Arbitrator,** Singapore Branch, Introduction to Commercial Arbitration 2024

**Skills:**

Advance Legal Research | Mediation and Negotiation | Case representation | Drafting of legal documents & procedural orders | Case Summarization | Documentation | Familiar with Arbitration rules| Communication| Case Coordination

**Languages:**

Dzongkha | English | Hindi| Bangla | Nepali| Sharchop| Kurteop| Lhotshamp